

Blest be the tie that binds

Text: John Fawcett, 1782, alt.

Music: Johann G. Nägeli, 1828; arr. Lowell Mason, 1845

DENNIS SM

The musical score is written for guitar and four-part vocal harmony. The guitar part is in the key of D major (two sharps) and 3/4 time. The vocal parts are arranged in four staves, each with a different starting pitch. The lyrics are written below the vocal staves. The score includes two systems of music. The first system covers the first two lines of the hymn, and the second system covers the next two lines. The guitar chords are indicated by letters (E, B7, A, etc.) and diagrams showing the fretting of the strings. The vocal parts are written in a four-part setting, with the soprano part on the top staff and the bass part on the bottom staff. The lyrics are written below the vocal staves, with each line of the hymn corresponding to a line of the four-part setting.

1 Blest be the tie that binds our hearts in Chris - tian love.
2 We share each oth - er's woes, each oth - er's bur - dens bear,
3 When we a - sun - der part, it gives us in - ward pain,
4 From sor - row, toil, and pain, and sin we shall be free,

The fel - low - ship of kin - dred minds is like to that a - bove.
and of - ten for each oth - er flows the sym - pa - thiz - ing tear.
but we shall still be joined in heart, and hope to meet a - gain.
and per - fect love and friend-ship reign through all e - ter - ni - ty.